

Employee Expense Claims Policy

Policy ID: EXP-2024-09

Effective: 1 January 2024

Owner: Finance & Compliance

1. Purpose & Scope

This policy defines eligible business expenses, approval thresholds, and documentation requirements for all Contoso employees. Claims submitted without valid receipts or outside defined categories will be declined without exception.

2. Eligible Expense Categories

Category	Per-Claim Limit	Approval Required	Conditions
IT Equipment & Peripherals	EUR 1,500 / item	Line Manager	Purchase from authorised vendors only (e.g. Contoso Store). Includes computers, tablets, styluses, and accessories directly required for job duties.
Business Meals (Solo) aka Meals	EUR 50 / meal	None	Receipt required. Must occur during a business trip or working day away from primary office. Itemised receipt preferred.
Business Meals (Client / Team)	EUR 250 / person	Line Manager	Names of attendees and business purpose must be documented. Alcohol capped at 50% of total.
Professional Services & Research	EUR 500	VP + Finance	Claims above EUR 500 require a pre-approved Purchase Order (PO) number on the invoice. Invoices without a valid PO number will be rejected.
Travel (Flights, Rail, Hotel)	Economy class only	Line Manager	Booking must be made via Contoso Travel Portal. Personal bookings reimbursed at economy equivalent only.
Foreign Currency Expenses	Per category limit	Per category	Submit in EUR, the Contoso home currency. Non-EUR receipts require the applicable exchange rate and its source. The original receipt is always required.

3. Non-Eligible Expenses (Automatic Rejection)

The following expense types will not be reimbursed under any circumstances:

- Personal, recreational, or leisure items (e.g. sporting goods, swimming equipment, garden or pool supplies)
- Clothing, personal grooming, or fitness memberships
- Alcohol purchases exceeding the 50% cap on client meals
- Fines, penalties, or legal fees not pre-approved by Legal
- Professional services invoices lacking a Contoso-issued Purchase Order number

4. Submission Requirements

- All claims must be submitted via the Contoso Expense Portal.
- Original receipts (photo or scan) must be attached. Credit card statements alone are not accepted.
- Invoices must show vendor name, date, itemised description, and total amount.
- Foreign-currency invoices must include the applicable exchange rate and source.